



Election Administrator Manual

Version dev

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Election Administrator Manual

This manual tells election administrators and trustees how to prepare, run and close an election with the Sequent Online Voting admin portal, version **9.0**.

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How to use this manual

1. Read [00-START](#) first. It gives the roles, the terms and the safety rules.
2. Do the procedures in the order of the table. Each procedure tells you what you must have before you start.
3. Use the [Reference](#) part when you need the details of a screen.

Procedures

Code	Procedure	Who	Result
00-START	Before you start: roles, terms and safety rules	All	You know who does each task.
01-TENANT	Set up the tenant: settings, users, roles and trustees	Tenant administrator	The administrators and trustees can sign in.
02-EVENT	Create the election event: elections, contests, candidates, areas and voters	Election administrator	The ballot content and the voter list are complete.

Code	Procedure	Who	Result
03-KEYS	Run the key ceremony	Election administrator and trustees	The election public key exists. Each trustee keeps a key fragment.
04-PUBLISH	Publish the ballot and open, pause and close the voting period	Election administrator	Voters can vote. Then the voting period is closed.
05-TALLY	Run the tally ceremony	Election administrator and trustees	The votes are decrypted and counted.
06-RESULTS	Get the results and the reports	Election administrator	You have the result documents.

Versions and languages

This manual is for the version of the platform in the version menu at the top of the page. To read the manual of another version, select it in the version menu. If you do not know the version of your platform, ask Sequent support.

Use the language menu to select a language. A page that is not translated shows in English.

00-START: Before you start

Read this page before you do a procedure. It gives the order of the work, the roles, the terms and the rules that keep the election secure.

The order of the work



Do the procedures in this order. You can change the ballot content after the key ceremony, but you must publish again after each change.

Roles

Role	Tasks	Default role in the admin portal
Sequent	Creates the tenant. Installs the trustee services. Gives you the first administrator account and the admin portal address.	-
Tenant administrator	Sets up the tenant. Creates the accounts of the other users.	admin
Election administrator	Creates and configures the election event. Starts the ceremonies. Publishes the ballot. Opens and closes the voting period. Gets the results.	admin
Trustee	Keeps one fragment of the election private key. Takes part in the key ceremony and in the tally ceremony.	trustee

One person can have more than one role. A trustee must not be the only person who controls the other trustees.

** NOTE**

Your organization can change the default roles. If a button or a tab in this manual is not on your screen, your account does not have the necessary permission. Ask your tenant administrator.

Terms

Term	Meaning
Tenant	The space of your organization on the platform. It contains your settings, your users and your election events.
Election event	The complete election process, from the configuration to the results. It contains one or more elections.
Election	One vote inside an election event. It contains one or more contests.
Contest	One question or one race on the ballot. It contains the candidates.
Candidate	One option that a voter can select in a contest.
Area	A group of voters, for example a district. An area tells which contests a voter sees.
Voter	A person who can vote in the election event. Each voter belongs to one area.
Trustee	A person who keeps one fragment of the election private key.
Threshold	The minimum number of trustees that must take part in the tally ceremony.

Term	Meaning
Key ceremony	The procedure that makes the election keys. Voters encrypt their ballots with the public key.
Key fragment	The part of the private key that one trustee keeps. In the admin portal it is the Encrypted Private Key file.
Publication	A version of the ballot that the voting portal shows to voters.
Voting channel	A way to vote: Online (voting portal) or Kiosk (voting kiosk).
Tally ceremony	The procedure that decrypts and counts the votes.
Sensitive action	An action for which the admin portal asks for your password again.

What you need

- A computer with an up-to-date version of Chrome, Firefox, Edge or Safari.
- The address of the admin portal. Sequent gives it to you.
- Your user name and password. The tenant administrator gives them to you.
- For trustees: two storage devices for the backups of the key fragment, for example two USB flash drives. Use devices that only you control.

Sign in to the admin portal

1. Open the admin portal address in the browser.
2. Type your user name and your password.
3. Click the sign-in button.
4. If the admin portal asks for a second factor, do the steps on the screen.

Expected result: the admin portal opens. The menu on the left shows your tenant and the items that your role permits:

Menu item	Use
Tenant name, with a + icon	Shows your tenant. Only Sequent can use the + icon.
Election Events	The list of election events. Click + to create or import an election event. Use Active and Archived to filter the list.
Users and Roles	The accounts of the administrators and trustees, and the roles.
Settings	The configuration of the tenant.
Templates	The templates of the messages and documents.
Help	Help links. This item shows only if your tenant has help links.

Under each election event, the menu shows a tree: election event, elections, contests and candidates. Click the three dots next to an item to see the actions for it.

Sensitive actions

Some actions need a recent confirmation of your identity, for example to publish the ballot or to open the voting period. When you do one of these actions, the admin portal shows: "The action you are about to perform is sensitive and requires confirmation."

1. Click **Confirm**.
2. Type your password on the sign-in page.

Expected result: the admin portal opens again and continues the action.

Safety rules

WARNING

Keep the key fragments secret and safe. If fewer trustees than the threshold have their key fragment at the tally ceremony, nobody can decrypt the votes. Nobody, Sequent included, can make a key fragment again.

- Each trustee keeps their own key fragment. Do not send a key fragment by email or chat.
- Do not give your password to another person. Each person uses their own account.
- Do the procedures from a trusted computer and network.
- Record the date, the time and the persons present at each ceremony. The admin portal also records the actions in the **Logs** tab of the election event.

Conventions in this manual

Convention	Meaning
Bold	A label on the screen: a button, a tab, a field or a menu item. The text is the same as on the screen.
Election Events > Data	Go to the first item, then to the second.
Expected result	What you see when the step is correct.
WARNING	A risk to the secrecy, the integrity or the availability of the election.
CAUTION	A risk of data loss, or an action that you cannot reverse.

Next: 01-TENANT: Set up the tenant.

01-TENANT: Set up the tenant

This procedure prepares the tenant for your election events. You set the tenant settings, you create the accounts of the administrators and trustees, and you make a backup of the configuration. The tenant administrator does this procedure once, before the first election event.

Before you start

- Sequent has created your tenant and has given you an account with the `admin` role.
- Sequent has installed the trustee services and has added the trustees to **Settings > TRUSTEES**.
- You have the list of persons: the administrators and the trustees, with their names and email addresses.
- For each trustee person, you know which trustee of the list they represent.

NOTE

Only Sequent can create a tenant. The + icon next to the tenant name does not work for other users.

1. Set the tenant settings

1. In the menu on the left, click **Settings**.
2. Click each tab and set the values. The table tells what each tab controls.

Tab	What it controls
ELECTION TYPES	The list of election types of the tenant.

Tab	What it controls
VOTING CHANELS	The voting channels that the tenant can use: Online Voting and Kiosk Voting . The admin portal saves a change immediately.
TEMPLATES	Shows if the tenant can send messages by email (Mails) and by text message (SMS). You cannot change these values. Ask Sequent support.
LANGUAGES	The languages that election events can use. Only the languages that you turn on here are available in the election events.
LOCALIZATION	Changes to the texts of the portals, for each language. Select the language, click Add , then type the Key and the Value .
Look & Feel	The Logo URL , the Custom CSS and the Help Links of the tenant. The help links show in the Help menu.
TRUSTEES	The list of trustees. Sequent adds the trustees. Do not change this list.
Countries	The countries from which voters cannot vote or enroll.
Backup / Restore	The backup and the restore of the tenant configuration. See step 4 .

3. On the **LANGUAGES** tab, turn on each language that your election events will use.
4. On the **VOTING CHANELS** tab, turn on each voting channel that your election events will use.
5. On the **TRUSTEES** tab, make sure that the list contains all the trustees.

Expected result: the settings show the values that you set. The **TRUSTEES** tab shows one row for each trustee.

2. Check the roles

A role is a set of permissions. Each user gets one or more roles.

1. In the menu on the left, click **Users and Roles**.
2. Click the **Roles** tab.
3. Make sure that the list contains the roles that you need, for example `admin` and `trustee`.
4. To see the permissions of a role, click the role. Each permission has a switch.

CAUTION

A change to a role applies immediately to all users with that role. Do not remove a permission from the `admin` role. If you do, you can lose access to a part of the admin portal.

To create a role:

1. On the **Roles** tab, click the create button.
2. Type the **Name** of the role.
3. Save the role.
4. Click the new role and turn on its permissions.

Expected result: the **Roles** tab shows the roles with the permissions that you need.

3. Create the user accounts

Do these steps for each administrator and for each trustee.

1. In the menu on the left, click **Users and Roles**.
2. Click the **Users** tab.
3. Click the create button. If the list is empty, click **Create user**.
4. Type the user name and the other fields of the form, for example the email address and the name.
5. Select **Enabled**.
6. Type a password in **Password:** and type it again in **Repeat Password:**.
7. Turn on **Temporary**. The user must then change the password at the first sign-in.
8. For a trustee only: in **Act as Trustee**, select the trustee that this person represents.
9. Save the user.
10. In the role list of the user, select **Active** for each role of the user:
 - Administrators: `admin`.

- Trustees: `trustee`.

11. Give the user name and the temporary password to the person. Use a secure channel.

WARNING

Give each trustee their own account and their own trustee in **Act as Trustee**. Two persons must not share one trustee. If one person controls more trustees than the threshold, that person can decrypt the votes alone.

Expected result: the **Users** tab shows the new users. Each user can sign in, changes the password and sees the menu items of their role.

4. Make a backup of the tenant configuration

Make a backup after you set up the tenant and after each important change.

1. In the menu on the left, click **Settings**.
2. Click the **Backup / Restore** tab.
3. Click **Backup**.
4. Wait for the task to finish. The browser downloads a file with the name `tenant-config-<tenant>-export.zip`.
5. Keep the file in a safe location. It contains the configuration of your tenant.

Expected result: you have the backup file.

CAUTION

A restore replaces the tenant configuration, the sign-in configuration and the roles. Do a restore only with the help of Sequent support.

If there is a problem

Problem	Action
The message "You don't have permission to access settings." shows.	Your account does not have the necessary permissions. Ask Sequent support to give your account the <code>admin</code> role.
The TRUSTEES tab is empty or a trustee is missing.	Ask Sequent support to add the trustees. You cannot do the key ceremony without them.
Online Voting shows as turned on after you turn it off.	This is a display error of version 9.0. Ask Sequent support to confirm the value.
Act as Trustee is not in the user form.	The user profile of the tenant does not have the trustee field. Ask Sequent support.
A user cannot sign in.	Make sure that Enabled is selected for the user. On the Users tab, use Change password to set a new temporary password.

Next: 02-EVENT: Create the election event.

02-EVENT: Create the election event

This procedure creates the election event and its content: the elections, the contests, the candidates, the areas and the voters. The election administrator does this procedure.

Before you start

- The tenant is ready. See [01-TENANT](#).
- You have the content of the ballot: the elections, the contests and the candidates, in all the languages of the election.
- You have the list of areas and the contests of each area.
- You have the voter list as a CSV file, or the data to create each voter.
- If you import an election event: you have the file and its SHA-256 hash.

The order of the steps is important. Create the areas after the contests, and the voters after the areas.

1. Create the election event

1. In the menu on the left, click the + icon next to **Election Events**.
2. Click **Create an Election Event**.
3. Type the **Name** of the election event.
4. Type the **Description**.
5. Click the save button.

Expected result: the message "Election Event created" shows. The admin portal opens the new election event. The election event shows these tabs:

Tab	Use
Dashboard	The numbers of the election event.

Tab	Use
Monitoring	The voting activity.
Data	The configuration of the election event.
Localization	The texts of the election event in each language.
Voters	The voter list.
Areas	The areas and their contests.
Keys	The key ceremony. See 03-KEYS .
Tally	The tally ceremony and the results. See 05-TALLY .
Publish	The publication of the ballot and the voting period. See 04-PUBLISH .
Tasks	The background tasks, for example imports and exports, with their status.
Logs	The record of the actions in the election event.
Scheduled Events	The automatic start and end of the voting period.
Reports	The reports and their schedule.
Approvals	The applications of voters who enroll.

Import an election event (alternative)

Use this method to make an election event from a file, for example a copy of an earlier election event.

1. In the menu on the left, click the **+** icon next to **Election Events**.
2. Click **Import Election Event**.

3. Type the hash of the file in **Integrity Check (SHA-256)**.
4. Drop the file in the upload area. The file can be a `.json` file, a `.zip` export or an encrypted `.ezip` export.
5. If the file is an `.ezip` file, type the password in **Decryption Password**.
6. Click **Import**.

Expected result: the message "Election event imported Successfully" shows.

CAUTION

If you do not type the hash, the admin portal asks "Import Without Integrity Check?". Click **Go Back** and type the hash. Without the hash, you cannot know if somebody changed the file.

2. Configure the election event

1. Open the election event.
2. Click the **Data** tab.
3. In **General**, type the **Name**, the **Alias** and the **Description** for each language.
4. In **Language**, select the languages of the election event. Select the **Default** language.
5. In **Voting Channels Allowed**, select **Online**, **Kiosk** or both.
6. In **Ballot Design**, set the logo and the other options of the voting portal.
7. In **Advanced Configurations**, make sure that **Lockdown Status** is **Not Locked Down**.
8. Click the save button.

Expected result: the admin portal saves the data. The menu shows the new name.

NOTE

Locked Down hides most tabs of the election event and stops all publications. Use it only when you must freeze the election event.

3. Create the elections

Do these steps for each election.

1. In the menu on the left, click the three dots next to the election event.
2. Click **Create an Election**.
3. Type the **Name**.
4. Type the **External ID**. This is the identifier of the election in your other systems.
5. Type the **Description**.
6. Click the save button.
7. Click the **Data** tab of the new election.
8. In **General**, type the name and the description for each language.
9. In **Voting Channels Allowed**, select the voting channels of this election.
10. In **Advanced Configuration**, set **Initialize Report Policy**. Select **Required** if you must make an initialization report before the voting period opens.
11. In **Custom filters**, set **Allow Tally**. The table gives the values.
12. Click the save button.

Allow Tally value	Meaning
Allowed	You can start the tally at any time.
Disallowed	You cannot start the tally.
Requires Voting Period End	You can start the tally only after the voting period is closed.

Expected result: the election shows under the election event in the menu.

NOTE

You cannot change the **External ID** after you save it.

4. Create the contests

Do these steps for each contest.

1. In the menu on the left, click the three dots next to the election.
2. Click **Create a Contest**.
3. Type the **Name** and the **Description**.

4. Click the save button.
5. Click the **Data** tab of the new contest.
6. In **Ballot Voting System**, make sure that the voting type is **No Preferential** and the counting algorithm is **Plurality at Large**. Version 9.0 has only these values.
7. In **Ballot Design**, set the number of votes:
 - The minimum number of selections. Type 0 if the voter can leave the contest blank.
 - The maximum number of selections.
 - The number of winning candidates.
8. In **Policies**, set what the voting portal does when a voter selects too few, too many or no candidates.
9. Click the save button.

Expected result: the contest shows under the election in the menu.

CAUTION

The admin portal does not check that the minimum is lower than the maximum. Check the values before you save. Make sure that the maximum is not higher than the number of candidates.

5. Create the candidates

Do these steps for each candidate.

1. In the menu on the left, click the three dots next to the contest.
2. Click **Create a Candidate**.
3. Type the **Name**.
4. Click the save button.
5. Click the **Data** tab of the new candidate.
6. In **General**, type the name and the description for each language.
7. In **Image**, add a photo or a logo if necessary.
8. Click the save button.

Expected result: the candidate shows under the contest in the menu.

6. Create the areas

An area tells which contests its voters see. Each voter belongs to one area.

1. Open the election event.
2. Click the **Areas** tab.
3. Click **Create Area**.
4. Type the **Name** and the **Description**.
5. In **Contests**, type three or more letters of a contest name, then select the contest. Do this for each contest of the area.
6. If the area is part of a larger area, select the parent area.
7. Click the save button.

Expected result: the message "Area created" shows. The area shows in the list.

Import areas (alternative)

1. On the **Areas** tab, click **Import**.
2. Upload a CSV file without a header row. Each row has five columns in this order: identifier, country code, code, area name, delete flag.
3. Use  in the delete flag column for each area to import.

CAUTION

An import links each imported area to **all** the contests of the election event. After the import, open each area and remove the contests that are not for that area.

7. Add the voters

Import the voters

1. Open the election event.
2. Click the **Voters** tab.
3. Click the import button. The **Import Voters** panel opens.
4. Click the link to download the example CSV file. Use it as a model.
5. Prepare your CSV file. The first row must be the header. The table gives the columns.

6. Upload the file.

Column	Content
<code>username</code>	The user name of the voter.
<code>email</code>	The email address.
<code>first_name</code> , <code>last_name</code>	The name of the voter.
<code>area_name</code>	The name of the area of the voter. It must be the same as in the Areas tab.
<code>enabled</code>	<code>TRUE</code> or <code>FALSE</code> . A voter with <code>FALSE</code> cannot sign in.
<code>password</code>	Optional. The password of the voter.
<code>sequent.read-only.mobile-number</code>	Optional. The mobile number, for text messages.

Other columns become attributes of the voter. Use a comma as separator. For a tab separator, give the file the extension `.tsv`.

Expected result: the message "Voters Import Scheduled Successfully" shows. When the task is complete on the **Tasks** tab, the voters show on the **Voters** tab.

Create one voter

1. On the **Voters** tab, click the create button.
2. Type the fields of the voter.
3. Select the **Area**.
4. Select **Enabled**.
5. Click the save button.

Expected result: the voter shows in the list.

If there is a problem

Problem	Action
The + icon next to Election Events is not there.	Your account does not have the permission to create election events. Ask your tenant administrator.
The import shows "Hashes don't match. Integrity check failure."	The file is not the file that you expect. Get the file again from its source. Do not import it without the check.
A language is not available in Language .	Turn on the language in Settings > LANGUAGES . See 01-TENANT .
The voter import fails on the Tasks tab.	Open the task to see the error. Check the header row and the area names, then import again.
A contest is not in the list of Contests of an area.	Type three or more letters of the contest name.

Next: [03-KEYS](#): Run the key ceremony.

03-KEYS: Run the key ceremony

The key ceremony makes the keys of the election. The voting portal encrypts each ballot with the public key. The private key is in fragments: each trustee keeps one fragment. To decrypt the votes, a minimum number of trustees (the threshold) must give their fragment at the tally ceremony.

The election administrator starts the ceremony. Then each trustee downloads, saves and checks their key fragment.

Before you start

- All the elections of the election event exist. See [02-EVENT](#).
- Each trustee has an account with the `trustee` role and the correct **Act as Trustee** value. See [01-TENANT](#).
- You know the threshold. It must be 2 or more, and not more than the number of trustees.
- Each trustee has two storage devices for the backups, for example two USB flash drives.
- You have agreed a date and a time with the trustees. All trustees must do their part.

WARNING

In version 9.0 you cannot cancel or restart a key ceremony from the admin portal. Check the threshold, the trustees and the election before you confirm. If you must change a key ceremony, contact Sequent support.

CAUTION

A key ceremony for **All Elections** stops you from making other key ceremonies in the election event. Create all the elections before you start it. If you add an election later, it cannot get keys.

1. Create the key ceremony (election administrator)

1. Open the election event.
2. Click the **Keys** tab.
3. Click **Create Keys Ceremony**. If the election event already has a key ceremony, click **Add**.
4. In **Threshold**, type the threshold.
5. In **Trustees**, select the trustees of the ceremony. Select a number of trustees that is equal to or more than the threshold.
6. In **Election**, select one election. To make one key for all the elections, leave the field empty. The ceremony then has the name **All Elections**.
7. Click **Create Keys Ceremony**.
8. Read the message "Are you sure you want to Create Keys Ceremony?".
9. Click **Yes, Create Keys Ceremony**.

Expected result: the message "Keys Ceremony created" shows. The ceremony shows in the list of the **Keys** tab. Its status is `STARTED`, and then `IN_PROGRESS`.

10. Tell the trustees that the key ceremony has started.

2. Save the key fragment (each trustee)

Each trustee does these steps on their own computer, with their own account.

1. Sign in to the admin portal.
2. Open the election event.
3. Click the **Keys** tab. The message "You have been invited to participate in a Keys ceremony." shows.
4. In the row of the ceremony, click the key icon in the **Actions** column.
5. Read the **Trustee Keys Ceremony** page. Make sure that the trustee name on the page is your trustee.
6. Click **Next**.

If the message "Waiting for Keys Generation.." shows, the trustee services have not made the keys yet. Wait one or two minutes. **Next** becomes available.

7. Click **Download your Encrypted Private Key**. The browser saves a file with the name `encrypted_private_key_trustee_<user>_<election>.txt`.
8. Copy the file to your first storage device.
9. Copy the file to your second storage device.
10. Click **Next**. The **Backup your Encrypted Private Key** window opens.
11. Select **First backup secured**.
12. Select **Second backup secured**.
13. Click **Confirm Backups and Continue**.
14. Drop the file from one storage device into the upload area of the **Check your Encrypted Private Key Backups** page.
15. Make sure that the message "Backup verified successfully." shows.
16. Click **Next**.
17. Delete the downloaded file from the computer. Keep only the two copies on the storage devices.
18. Keep the two storage devices in two different safe locations.

WARNING

Do not give your key fragment to another person, and do not send it by email or chat. Keep it until the end of the tally ceremony and the end of the period for claims. If too many trustees lose their fragment, nobody can decrypt the votes.

Expected result: the **Finished** step shows the progress of the ceremony.

3. Check that the ceremony is complete (election administrator)

1. Open the election event.
2. Click the **Keys** tab.
3. Click the view icon of the ceremony. The **Keys Ceremony Progress** page opens.
4. Make sure that each trustee has a tick in these columns:
 - **Key Fragment Generated**
 - **Private Key Fragment Downloaded**

- **Private Key Fragment Checked**

Expected result: the status is `SUCCESS`. The status changes to `SUCCESS` only when all trustees have checked their key fragment.

4. Record the date, the time, the trustees present and the result of the ceremony.

Ceremony status

Status	Meaning
<code>STARTED</code>	The ceremony is created.
<code>IN_PROGRESS</code>	The trustees can download and check their key fragment.
<code>SUCCESS</code>	All trustees have checked their key fragment. The ceremony is complete.
<code>CANCELLED</code>	The ceremony is cancelled.

If there is a problem

Problem	Action
"You selected threshold ... but it must be between ... and ..."	Type a threshold between 2 and the number of trustees.
"You selected only ... trustee(s), but you must select at least ..."	Select more trustees, or type a lower threshold.
The Keys tab is not there for a trustee.	The account does not have the <code>trustee</code> role. Ask your tenant administrator.
The trustee does not see the key icon.	Make sure that Act as Trustee of the account is the trustee of the ceremony.

Problem	Action
"Invalid Encrypted Private Key Backup, please try again"	Use the file from the other storage device. If both fail, click Back and download the file again.
"Private key download is no longer available because the ceremony has moved on."	You cannot download the file again. Use your backups.
"there's already an existing running ceremony ..."	The election, or all the elections, already have a key ceremony. Contact Sequent support if you must replace it.
The status stays at <code>IN_PROGRESS</code> .	A trustee has not checked their key fragment. Look at the trustee table and contact that trustee.

Next: 04-PUBLISH: Publish the ballot and manage the voting period.

04-PUBLISH: Publish the ballot and manage the voting period

This procedure makes the ballot available in the voting portal, then opens, pauses and closes the voting period. The election administrator does this procedure.

Before you start

- The content of the election event is complete and correct. See [02-EVENT](#).
- The key ceremony status is `SUCCESS`. See [03-KEYS](#).
- Your account has the permissions to publish and to change the voting status.
- You know your password. Publication and the voting status are sensitive actions. See [00-START](#).

WARNING

Do not publish before the key ceremony status is `SUCCESS`. Version 9.0 does not stop you. A ballot that you publish without the public key cannot be encrypted correctly.

1. Make a publication

1. Open the election event.
2. Click the **Publish** tab.
3. Click **Generate Publication**. If the election event already has a publication, click **Publish Changes**.
4. Read the message "You are about to generate a publication."
5. Click **Confirm**. If the admin portal asks for your password, type it.

Expected result: the message "Ballot generated" shows. The **Changes to be Published** page compares the **Current** publication with the **Changes to Publish**.

6. Read the changes. Make sure that they are the changes that you expect.

2. Preview the ballot

1. On the **Changes to be Published** page, click **Preview**.
2. In **Select Area for Preview**, select an area.
3. Open the preview. To send the preview to another person, click **Copy link**.
4. Check the ballot of the area: the elections, the contests, the candidates, the texts in each language and the number of selections.
5. Do steps 2 to 4 for each area.

If you find an error, correct it in the election event. Then start again at step 1 of [Make a publication](#).

3. Publish the ballot

1. On the **Changes to be Published** page, click **Publish Changes**.
2. Confirm the action.

Expected result: the message "Ballot published" shows. The **Publish History** list shows the new publication.

NOTE

To change the ballot after you publish it, change the election event and do this procedure again from step 1. Voters see the last publication.

4. Make the initialization report (if necessary)

Do this step only if **Initialize Report Policy** of an election is **Required**. The initialization report shows that the ballot box is empty before the voting period opens. **Start Voting** stays unavailable until the report exists.

1. Open the election event.
2. Click the **Tally** tab.

3. Click **Generate Initialization Report**.
4. Select the elections in **Elections for Initialization Report**.
5. Click **Start Initialization Report**.
6. Continue as in a tally ceremony. See [05-TALLY](#).

Expected result: the **Tally** list shows a row with the **Tally Type Initialization Results**.

5. Open the voting period

Do this step at the time of the start of the voting period. To open the voting period automatically, use [scheduled events](#).

1. Open the election event.
2. Click the **Publish** tab.
3. Click **Start Voting**.
4. Read the message "You are about to start voting period."
5. Confirm the action. If the admin portal asks for your password, type it.

Expected result: the message "Election status changed" shows. Voters can vote in the voting portal on the voting channels of the election event.

6. Sign in to the voting portal with a test voter account, if you have one, and make sure that the ballot shows.

6. Pause or close the voting period

To stop the voting for a short time:

1. On the **Publish** tab, click **Pause Voting**.
2. Confirm the action.
3. To continue, click **Start Voting** and confirm the action.

To close the voting period at its end:

WARNING

In version 9.0 you cannot open the voting period again from the admin portal after you close it. Close the voting period only at its official end.

1. On the **Publish** tab, click **Stop Voting**. This closes the **Online** channel.
2. Confirm the action.
3. If the election event uses kiosks, click **Stop Kiosk Voting** and confirm the action.

Expected result: the message "Election status changed" shows. Voters cannot vote.

7. Schedule the voting period (alternative)

Use scheduled events to open and close the voting period at a set time.

1. Open the election event.
2. Click the **Scheduled Events** tab.
3. Click **Create Scheduled Event**.
4. In **Type**, select **Start Voting Period**.
5. In **Election**, select an election. Leave it empty for all the elections.
6. Type the date and the time. The admin portal uses the time zone of your computer. The label of the field shows the time zone.
7. Click the save button.
8. Do steps 3 to 7 again with the type **End Voting Period**.

Expected result: the **Scheduled Events** tab shows the two events.

CAUTION

Check the time zone in the label of the date field. If your computer is not in the time zone of the election, convert the times.

If there is a problem

Problem	Action
"Election event is locked down"	Set Lockdown Status to Not Locked Down on the Data tab. See 02-EVENT .

Problem	Action
"Ballot publication not generated yet, can't publish."	Make a publication first. See step 1 .
"Insufficient privileges"	Confirm your identity again with your password, then repeat the action.
Start Voting is not available.	Make the initialization report, if the election needs one. If the voting period is closed, contact Sequent support.
Stop Voting is not available.	A scheduled event does not permit the end of the voting period yet. Look at the Scheduled Events tab.
Voters do not see a contest.	Make sure that the contest is in the area of the voter. Then make and publish a new publication.

Next: 05-TALLY: Run the tally ceremony.

05-TALLY: Run the tally ceremony

The tally ceremony decrypts and counts the votes. The election administrator creates the tally. The trustees upload their key fragments. When enough trustees have uploaded their fragment, the election administrator starts the tally.

Before you start

- The key ceremony status is `SUCCESS`. See [03-KEYS](#).
- The election event has a publication. See [04-PUBLISH](#).
- The voting period is closed, unless you make an initialization report.
- **Allow Tally** of each election permits the tally. See [02-EVENT](#).
- A number of trustees equal to or more than the threshold are available, with one copy of their key fragment.
- You have agreed a date and a time with the trustees.

WARNING

Start the tally of the election results only after the official end of the voting period. If **Allow Tally** is **Allowed**, the admin portal lets you start the tally while voters can still vote.

1. Create the tally (election administrator)

1. Open the election event.
2. Click the **Tally** tab.
3. Click **Start Tally Ceremony**.
4. In **Elections to Tally**, select the elections to count.
5. In **Keys Ceremony**, select the key ceremony of these elections. If there is only one key ceremony, the admin portal selects it.

6. Click **Start Tally Ceremony**.
7. Read the message "This action will notify the trustees to import their key fragments."
8. Click **Ok**.

Expected result: the message "Tally created" shows. The tally shows in the list of the **Tally** tab with the status **STARTED**.

9. Tell the trustees that the tally ceremony has started.

2. Upload the key fragment (each trustee)

Each trustee does these steps with their own account. You need one copy of your key fragment from your storage device.

1. Sign in to the admin portal.
2. Open the election event.
3. Click the **Tally** tab. The message "You have been invited to participate in a Tally ceremony." shows.
4. In the row of the tally, click **Add Tally Key** in the **Actions** column.
5. Read the list of **Elections to Tally**. Make sure that it is the list that you expect.
6. Drop your key fragment file into the upload area.
7. Make sure that the message "Backup verified successfully." shows.
8. Click **Next**.
9. Remove the storage device and keep it in its safe location.

Expected result: the trustee has uploaded the key fragment.

3. Start the tally (election administrator)

1. On the **Tally** tab, click the view icon of the tally.
2. Look at the **Trustees** section. It shows how many trustees have imported their key and how many are necessary.
3. Wait until the status is **CONNECTED**. This status shows that enough trustees have uploaded their key fragment.

4. Click **Start Tally**.
5. Read the message "Do you want to start the Tally?".
6. Click **Start Tally**.

Expected result: the message "Tally started" shows. The status changes to `IN_PROGRESS`. The **Elections Tally Progress** table shows the progress of each election.

7. Wait until the status is `SUCCESS`. The time depends on the number of votes.
8. Click **Results**. See [06-RESULTS](#).
9. Record the date, the time, the trustees present and the result of the ceremony.

Tally status

Status	Meaning
<code>STARTED</code>	The tally is created. The trustees can upload their key fragments.
<code>CONNECTED</code>	Enough trustees have uploaded their key fragment. You can start the tally.
<code>IN_PROGRESS</code>	The platform mixes, decrypts and counts the votes.
<code>SUCCESS</code>	The tally is complete. The results are available.
<code>CANCELLED</code>	The tally is cancelled.

The **Elections Tally Progress** table shows these steps for each election: `WAITING`, `MIXING`, `DECRYPTING`, `SUCCESS` or `ERROR`.

Cancel a tally

You can cancel a tally before it starts, when its status is `STARTED` or `CONNECTED`.

⚠ CAUTION

You cannot undo a cancellation. The trustees must upload their key fragment again for a new tally.

1. On the **Tally** tab, click **Cancel Tally Ceremony** in the row of the tally.
2. Click **Cancel Tally**.

If there is a problem

Problem	Action
"The Tally Ceremony cannot start until the Keys Ceremony has been successfully completed."	Complete the key ceremony. See 03-KEYS .
"The Tally Ceremony cannot start until you create one publication in the Publish tab."	Publish the ballot. See 04-PUBLISH .
"You cannot continue the ceremony because no elections are selected or the elections are not published."	Select one or more published elections.
"Elections have different keys ceremonies"	Make one tally for each key ceremony.
"You cannot continue the ceremony because the tally session is not connected or the start of the ceremony is not allowed."	Wait for more trustees. If the status is CONNECTED , check Allow Tally of each election and close the voting period.
"Trustee not part of the keys ceremony or has invalid state"	The trustee is not in the key ceremony of these elections, or has already uploaded the fragment.
A trustee's file is not accepted.	Use the copy from the other storage device. Make sure it is the file of this election event.

Problem	Action
An election shows <code>ERROR</code> .	Do not start a new tally. Contact Sequent support and give the name of the election event.

Next: 06-RESULTS: Get the results.

06-RESULTS: Get the results

This procedure shows the results of a tally and downloads the result documents. The election administrator does this procedure.

Before you start

- The tally status is **SUCCESS**. See [05-TALLY](#).
- Your account has the permission to export the results.

1. Look at the results

1. Open the election event.
2. Click the **Tally** tab.
3. Click the view icon of the tally.
4. Click **Results**.
5. Open **Results & Participation**.
6. Select the election, the contest and the area to see.

Expected result: the page shows:

- The **Participation Summary**: the eligible voters, the votes counted, and the valid, invalid and blank votes, with their percentages.
 - The **Candidate Results**: the votes of each candidate and the winning positions.
7. Compare the number of votes counted with the number of votes cast in the **Dashboard** tab.

2. Download the result documents

You can download the results of the election event, an election, a contest or an area.

1. On the results page, open the actions menu of the item.

2. Click the format to download. The menu shows the formats that exist for the item.

Format	Content
PDF	The results document, ready to print and sign.
HTML	The results document, for a browser. You can also make a PDF from it.
JSON	The results in a data format, for other systems.
TAR_GZ	An archive with all the result files.
RECEIPTS_PDF	The vote receipts.

3. Keep the files in a safe location.

Expected result: the browser saves the file.

3. Make the reports

The **Reports** tab makes other documents, for example the electoral results report, a statistical report or the activity log.

1. Open the election event.
2. Click the **Reports** tab.
3. Click **Create Report**.
4. Select the **Report Type**, for example **Electoral Results**.
5. Select the **Election** and the **Template**.
6. In **Encryption Policy**, select **Configured Password** to protect the file with a password, or **Unencrypted**.
7. Click the save button.
8. In the row of the report, click **Generate**.

Expected result: the report is available to download when its task is complete.

4. Publish the results

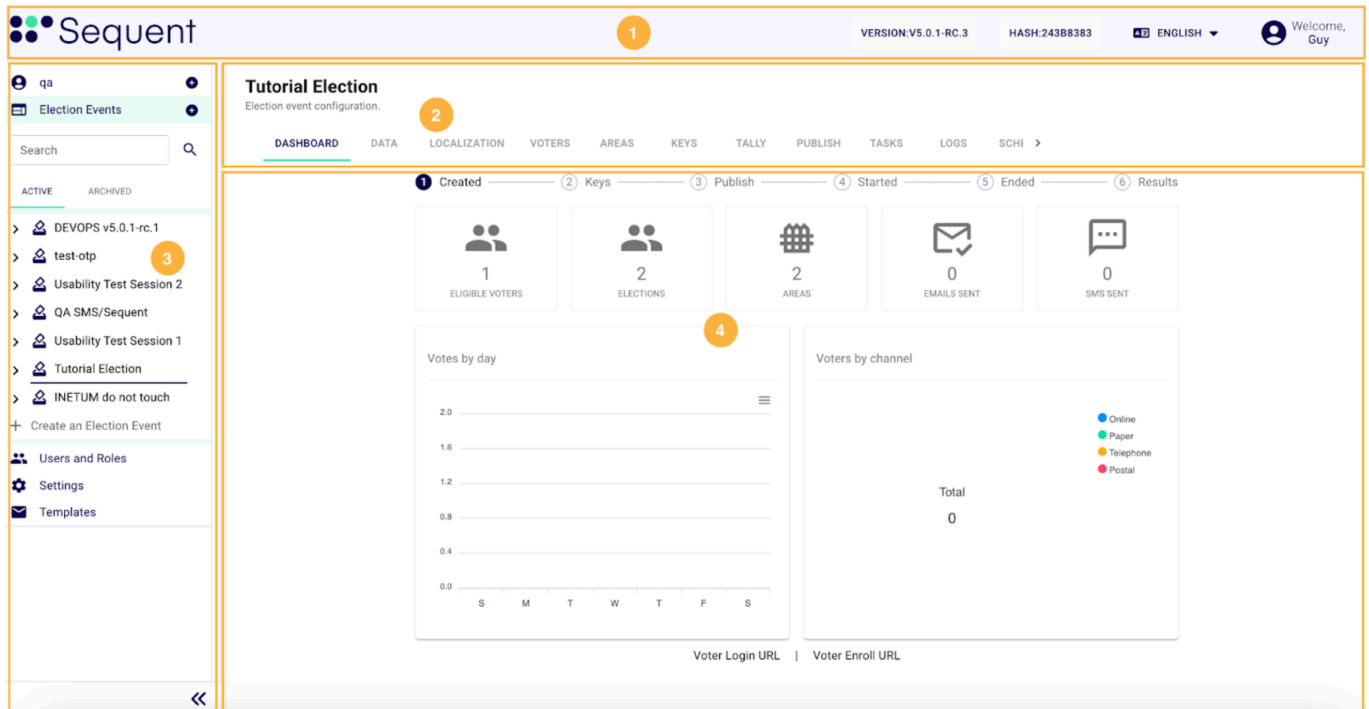
Version 9.0 does not publish the results to a public website. Give the result documents to the persons who announce the results.

5. Keep the records

1. Export the election event for your archive. On the **Data** tab, click the export button, then select the content to include. Select **Encrypt with Password**.
2. Keep the export file, the result documents and the records of the ceremonies together.
3. Keep the key fragments until the end of the period for claims. Then destroy them as your rules require.

If there is a problem

Problem	Action
The Results button is not available.	The tally is not complete. Wait until the status is SUCCESS .
A format is not in the menu.	The platform did not make that document for the item. Contact Sequent support.
The number of votes is not what you expect.	Do not publish the results. Check the publication, the areas and the Logs tab, then contact Sequent support.



Basic Navigation

The system's user interface (UI) is divided into four main areas, each serving a specific function:

1. **Header (Top Bar)**
2. **Navigation Tabs (Under Election Event Title)**
3. **Side Menu (Left Sidebar)**
4. **Main Content Area (Data Display)**

1. Header

The header, located at the top of the screen, provides global controls and essential information that are always accessible. This area includes:

- **System Logo and Version Number:** The logo of the system, along with the current version number, is displayed prominently for easy identification.
- **Language Selector:** A dropdown menu that allows users to switch between different languages, ensuring that the system is accessible to a broader audience.

- **Account Icon:** An icon that provides access to user account settings and the option to log out of the system. This is where users can manage their profile information and security settings.
-

2. Navigation Tabs

The navigation tabs under the selected entity title let you easily browse different sections, each showing specific information. Each entity has several unique tabs designed for its specific functions and data. This setup makes it easy to find and manage all the details related to each entity.

3. Side Menu

The side menu, located on the left of the screen, provides easy access to **Election Events**, **Settings**, **Users**, **Roles**, and **Communication Templates**. This omnipresent menu ensures seamless navigation across all screens, allowing you to quickly access system settings and manage Election Events.

This section of the screen is one of the most critical areas of the system. It contains the **Election Event tree**, where you can access and create **Elections**, **Contests/Questions**, or **Candidates/Answers**.

To facilitate navigation, a **search field** is provided that allows you to search within the election event section and its entire tree structure for any entity name, whether it be a Question, Candidate, or Election.

Election Events are categorized into **Active** and **Archived** for better organization. This allows users to archive election events that have been finalized or used for testing purposes, maintaining a clean tree structure with only the events currently in progress.

4. Main Content Area

The main content area, situated in the center of the screen, displays the currently selected section, whether it is an **Election Event**, **Settings**, or **Communication Templates**,

among others.

Each section can contain additional tabs that provide more detailed options and settings related to the chosen topic. This layout ensures that users have a comprehensive view and easy access to all relevant functionalities and information.

Trustees Settings

The Trustees settings section in the Admin Portal allows you to manage and configure the trustees for your elections. Trustees are critical components that hold shares of the election's cryptographic keys, ensuring the security and integrity of the voting process.

Overview

In the STEP voting system, trustees work together to:

- Generate and manage cryptographic keys for elections
- Participate in the decryption process during tallying
- Ensure no single entity can compromise the election's security

Configuration

Trustees in STEP are deployed as containerized services using the Braid trustee implementation. Each trustee requires specific configuration including:

- Unique trustee identifier
- Connection details to the B3 service
- Database credentials
- Secrets management backend configuration

Technical Documentation

For detailed information about configuring Braid Trustees, including:

- Environment variables
- Secrets management options
- Docker deployment
- Security considerations

Please refer to the comprehensive [Braid Trustees Configuration Guide](#).

Managing Trustees in Admin Portal

This section will be updated with specific instructions for managing trustees through the Admin Portal interface.

Adding Trustees

Coming soon...

Monitoring Trustee Status

Coming soon...

Key Ceremony Process

Coming soon...

Admin Portal Reference

User Manual Settings

Localization

Localization Overrides

To customize the display label of a user attribute, add a translation override via the Admin Portal under **Settings > Localization > Add**.

User attribute keys must use the prefix `usersAndRolesScreen.users.fields.` followed by the attribute name.

Example: to display the `personal_administrative_number` attribute as "PAN", add the following to the tenant's localization settings:

Key: `usersAndRolesScreen.users.fields.personal_administrative_number` Value: `PAN`

This works for any attribute name, including custom ones not present in the default translations.